Unit 1 Section 3 – Marketing Mix

Exam Patterns & Trends

Exam Series	Topics Tested	Question Type
Jan 2019	Product life cycle / branding	6–10 marks
Jun 2020	Pricing strategy / promotion	8–10 marks
Jan 2021	Boston Matrix / distribution	6–8 marks
Oct 2021	Branding and product mix	8 marks
Jun 2022	Price and promotional mix	10 marks
Jan 2023	Design mix / sustainability	6–10 marks
Oct 2024	Promotion and digital marketing	8–10 marks

Summary of Patterns

All four elements of the marketing mix are tested regularly across exam cycles. Product and promotion appear in nearly every series, while price and distribution rotate. Design mix and sustainability have grown in prominence since 2023.

Predictions for Jan 2026

- Product differentiation and product portfolio balance
- Pricing strategy linked to elasticity and competitiveness
- Digital promotion and brand image management
- Sustainability in design and packaging
- Distribution efficiency and online channels